

Getting people involved

"Test marketing" of a new product or service helps explore customer preferences that provide information about things like pricing policy or advertising, and checks if people really want the new offering. Such testing also offers the chance to test different launch strategies—for example, two different regions could be used, each employing a different launch strategy.

The same principle holds for process innovations inside the organization—changes in "the way we do things around here." Getting the ideas and insights of people who will be using the new process is an ideal way of improving the final design of the process as well as smoothing the route to change.

TIP

MAKE USE OF TESTERS

When implementing a new procedure, invite those involved in the testing to help train and support new users.

Maximizing your chances

Three factors determine the speed at which an innovation diffuses: the nature of the innovation (radical innovations are adopted more slowly than small ones), the characteristics of the adopter (some communities are more receptive to change), and the personality of the innovator. It makes sense to allow more time and resources to promote a radical change in a conservative community than a small change in a flexible workforce.



share
potential
product
preferences
try
adopt
test
test